Palm OS Programming Recipes

Recipe: Switching between forms

Sometimes an application needs to switch between two normal forms that are not dialogs. For example, the Memo application has a List view and an Edit view, which it switches between. They are not layered on top of each other, but rather are standalone; only one is loaded and active at a time.

To make a second form, first create its resources in Constructor:

1. Create a new form object, name it "Secondary", and set its title to "Secondary" as well.
2. Set its bounds to 0, 0, 160, 160, and its attributes to be usable, not modal, and turn off "Save Behind". (A modal form would have bounds of 2, 2, 156, 156, so that its border was displayed correctly.)
3. There should be no default button ID; leave it zero.
4. Add some objects to the form, to display or edit your data.
5. Add a button to go back to the main form. Set its identifier to "GoToPrimary", and set its label as you choose. ("Done" might be appropriate.)
6. Add a button to your main form which will be used to go to this new secondary form. Call it "GoToSecondary".

Add the following code to your main form's event handler, to go to the secondary form:

```
if ((eventP->eType == ctlSeletcEvent) &&
    (eventP->data.ctlSelect.controlID == MainGoToSecondaryButton))
{
   FrmGotoForm(SecondaryForm);
   handled = true;
}
```

You also need an event handler for the second form. Here is one that does nothing but handle the button which will return to the main form. Yours will also initialize your UI objects, handle frmUpdateEvent, and handle other normal events. Remember that your main form's event handler is no longer active, since that form has been closed in the process of opening this secondary one.

```
static Boolean SecondaryHandleEvent(EventPtr eventP)
{
   FormType *frmP;
   Boolean handled = false;

   switch (eventP->eType) {
      case frmOpenEvent:
         frmP = FrmGetActiveForm();
         /* initialize UI objects here */
         FrmDrawForm(frmP);
         handled = true;
         break;

      case ctlSelectEvent:
         if (eventP->data.ctlSelect.controlID == SecondaryGoToPrimaryButton) {
            FrmGotoForm(MainForm);
            handled = true;
            break;
         }
```

```
         default:
            break;
      }
      return handled;
   }
```

Your AppHandleEvent routine needs to set the event handler for the secondary form, like this:

```
   case SecondaryForm:
      FrmSetEventHandler(frmP, SecondaryHandleEvent);
      break;
```

The form is allocated and loaded by your AppHandleEvent, and is freed by FrmGotoForm. Note that AppHandleEvent is implemented in your code. If you are not using the defualt stationery that comes with the SDK, each form is allocated and loaded with FrmInitForm and FrmSetActiveForm respectively. Take a look at the stationery for an example of how this is done.